

Data Dictionary

This case study uses two datasets, which can be found in this repository:

<https://github.com/bowenslingluff/DS4002-CS3>

1. Data/fantasy_dataset_final.csv
2. Data/text_dataset.json

The goal is to evaluate whether fantasy analyst sentiment is genuinely predictive of player performance, or mainly reflects known information and media narratives.

1) fantasy_dataset_final.csv

Key fields

<u>Column</u>	<u>Column Name</u>	<u>Description</u>	<u>Example</u>
NFL Season Week	week	The week of the NFL regular season corresponding to the data point.	1, 2, ..., 18
Player Name	player_name	The full name of the NFL player associated with the fantasy football data record.	Drake Maye
Position	position	The player's primary on-field position (Offensive players only)	QB, WR, RB, TE, K
Team Abbreviated	Team	3 letter abbr. for the NFL team the player was rostered on at the time the data was recorded.	NE (New England Patriots)
Fantasy Points Scored	TotalPoints	The total number of fantasy points the player scored during that specific NFL week, based on standard fantasy scoring rules.	0 - 55.4
VADER Compound Sentiment Score	sentiment_compound	An overall sentiment score produced by the VADER sentiment analysis tool that summarizes the emotional tone of an article by combining positive, negative, and neutral sentiment into a single normalized value ranging from -1 (most negative) to +1 (most positive). Higher values indicate more positive sentiment.	.74 (strongly positive) -.84 (strongly negative)

Unit of observation

- A player mention tied to a given NFL week, with sentiment and performance fields merged into one row.

Primary use in this case study

- Compare sentiment to outcomes (e.g., 'TotalPoints', 'Rank')
- Check whether stronger tone aligns with better actual results
- Evaluate possible narrative/bias effects

Notes:

- sentiment_compound is measured on a scale from -1 to 1. 1 being the most positive, -1 being the most negative.
- If multiple analysts discuss the same player/week, you may see multiple rows for that player-week.

2) text_dataset.json

Unit of observation

- One fantasy article entry containing metadata and extracted player references.

Primary use in this case study

- Inspect how analysts frame players in language
- Identify possible narrative patterns (hype, recency bias, caution framing)
- Connect qualitative writing style to quantitative sentiment

Structure

- text_dataset.json is a list of article objects.

```
[
  {
    "meta_title": Article title,
    "meta_url": Article link,
    "meta_date": Article Publication Date,
    "intro_text": Article summary/introduction,
    ** players is a JSON Array of player analyses from the corresponding article.
    "players": [
      {
        "name": Player name,
        "raw_header": Raw article Header,
        "type": Article Type,
        "analysis": Paragraph analysis
      },
      ...
    ]
  }
]
```